

## "We took a shortcut with Honeycomb," says Android chief

Google has admitted that while releasing Honeycomb onto devices, they took a shortcut and overlooked a few design elements in order to meet release deadlines. This might be the real reason why Honeycomb still isn't open source. Other than the direct partners of Google in the Android project, like Motorola, nobody has access to the source code.



"To make our schedule to ship the tablet, we made some design trade-offs," said Andy Rubin, vice president of engineering and head of the Android group. "We didn't want to think about what it would take for the same software to run on phones. It would have required a lot of additional resources and extended our schedule beyond what we thought was reasonable. So we took a shortcut," Rubin added.

Ever since it came out, enthusiasts have been speculating about Honeycomb finally making it to smartphones. Apparently, Android's next version, Ice Cream, due sometime in May, would be an effort to marry Gingerbread and Honeycomb. One of the few devices that has been rumoured to run Honeycomb when it is out in the wild is HTC's Pyramid.

## Motorola wants to do a Defy in tablets



According to a leaked presentation copy, Motorola is working on a rugged tablet that could be targeted at professionals out in the field. Some may recall that Motorola has already developed such a smartphone called Defy, which is shock and dust proof and resistant to water. So the expertise is already there; they just need to replicate it on a bigger platform.

The presentation slide also informs us that the rugged tablet would be able to survive four foot falls on plywood. Other features include a stylus to capture signatures, a fingerprint scanner, a removable battery lasting for up to 5.5 hours of viewing video, an 8 MP rear camera, a 1.3 MP front camera, a 17.8-cm (7-inch) capacitive LCD and the Android Gingerbread mobile OS.

## New Symbian version announced



Nokia has announced a new Symbian version that looks like a worthy attempt at renewing the dying Symbian smartphone. Featuring 50 plus improvements, the new version called Anna will bring in much demanded features such as a QWERTY keyboard, improved Ovi maps, a new browser, new icons and many others.

Nokia's Anna has something for business users too. Instant messaging via the Microsoft Communicator mobile and hardware-accelerated device encryption are just some of the features worth mentioning.

The new version brings with it a confirmation about Nokia's forthcoming device X7, which is made of stainless steel and is an attempt to 'renew the Symbian smartphone'. In all, Anna's improvements will be rolled out to Nokia N8, C7, C6-01 and E7 in the coming months.

Of late, Nokia has been found lagging when it came to the overall user experience in smartphones, while Android and iOS have been improving with every update. Hopefully, this should excite Android and iPhone converts enough to give Symbian a second chance.

## Call Facebook friends for free on Android

You can catch up with friends online, on Facebook. But that doesn't match the warmth of hearing a loved one's voice or viewing a live image of the person. While several modern apps make it free or economical to contact your loved ones around the globe, what they require from you and your friend is to be on the same platform/app. So you have been able to chat with a friend of yours because both of you are online on Facebook and hence the communication. So is the case with any other video calling app, chat client or IM.

However, a new app, called JaJa for Android, lets you make voice calls to your Facebook friends even if they are not using the same app. You can make free voice calls to online Facebook friends without even keying-in their numbers. Just tap on the person on Facebook chat, whom you want to speak to, and they will receive an IM containing a link to a voice call. Once they click on it, you can start talking!



## LG Optimus 2X to get Gingerbread in June

According to LG's Denmark support website, the P990 (the internal code number for the LG Optimus 2X) will be updated to Android 2.3 sometime in the middle of this year – either in June or July. The company says it will share more details about the update closer to the release date.

LG Optimus 2X is touted to be the first dual core Android smartphone in the world. It features a 10.2-cm (4-inch) display, an 8 mega-pixel primary camera with a 1.3 mega-pixel front cam, 8 GB internal storage and a 1500 mAh battery.

